



Secondary Education · Session 4

Learning Design

Students come first

Move from understanding to design without turning students into a list of problems.

Start with the real students you have in mind, a specific access question and evidence from your secondary day map and audit. The design response comes after understanding.

How this session runs

Short inputs, then doing. You work in trios and keep your own students in view.

1

Regroup

5 min · Move and form trios

2

Brief

8 min · Trios

3

Options

15 min · Input, then trios

4

Universal first

8 min · Trios

5

Design

10 min · Trios

6

Check

7 min · On your own, private

7

Continuum

8 min · Input

8

Gallery and commit

10 min · Whole room

You will leave with one lesson, assessment task or handover redesigned, tested against real students, and one thing to try.

Regroup

Bring back your Carry into design card from Session 3.

Move to the corner of the room for what you will redesign:

A lesson

An assessment task

A handover

Form a trio with two people near you. Each of you keeps your own two or three students in mind.

5 minutes

Keep your students in view

Hold a concise picture of each of the students you have in mind, including:

**Strengths, interests
and joy**

**Communication,
sensory experience
and thinking**

**What costs and what
lightens**

Identity and belonging

**What students,
families and the team
already know**

**Questions that remain
open**

You are not building a file on one young person. Keep real, different students in view as you design.

Write your trio's brief

Agree on one lesson, assessment task or handover you all recognise, then write an environment-first brief.

This asks students to...

For some students, that means...

We could change...

Check the wording: is it specific, workable and free from blame or deficit labels?

Options menu

Four short inputs. Listen for what might answer your brief.

1

Executive functioning meets assessment

Schedules early, tasks chunked, exemplars shown

2

Predictability across the timetable

Clear information about routine and change

3

Supports that travel

Consistent guidance shared across the timetable

4

Visual supports

Clarify what students need to find, understand, remember or communicate

Printed option cards are on your table. After the inputs, your trio chooses one or two.

Executive functioning meets assessment

Match support to a known demand:

Publish assessment schedules early

Chunk tasks with visible milestones

Show an exemplar of the finished thing

Make submission steps literal

When a task is missed, look at starting, planning and time before assuming a student didn't care.

Predictability across the timetable

Predictability includes clear information about routine and change.

Help students answer:



**What is
happening?**



**What is
changing?**



**What comes
next?**



**What can I do if
the plan
changes?**

Give information early enough to be useful, in every class and on relief days.

Supports that travel

One page, shared across the timetable.

A short profile of strengths, interests, what helps and what costs, written with the student and shared with every teacher, including relief teachers. Decide where it lives so it is actually seen.

A large, light purple rectangular area with a dashed border, intended for an image.

Image placeholder

Would a relief teacher, or the period 4 teacher, know what helps before the lesson starts?

Visual supports

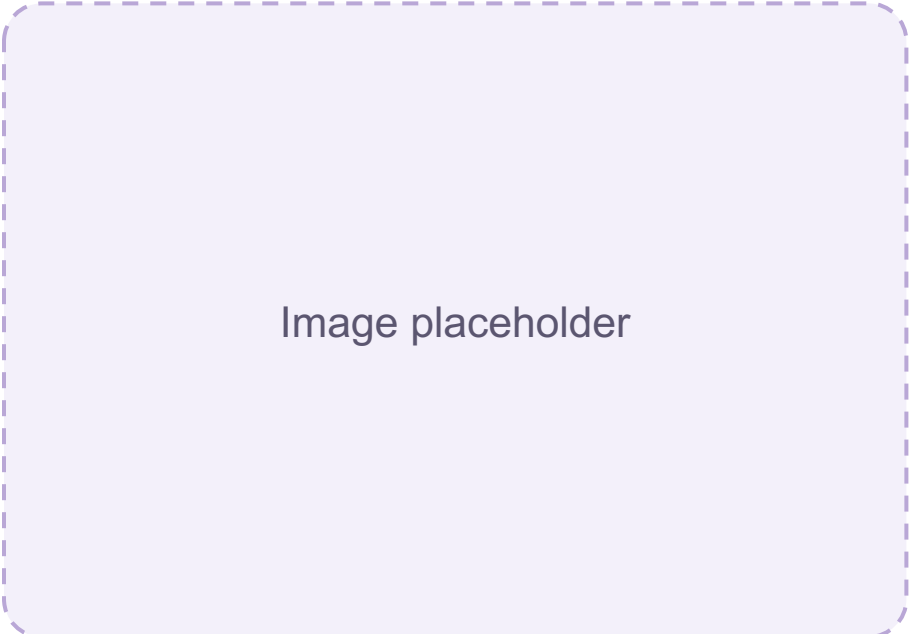
A large, light purple rounded rectangle with a dashed border, intended for an image.

Image placeholder

Visual Supports Checklist

Online webinar available to explore visual supports in greater depth.

A visual support should clarify something the student needs to find, understand, remember or communicate.

Keep it available at the point of use, avoid unnecessary detail, explain how it works and check its meaning and usefulness with the student.

Quick review of a visual support

- Can the student understand it?
- Can they access it when they need it?
- Does it reflect what is actually happening, including change?
- Does it provide useful information or a way to respond?

Choose your options

Which one or two options answer your brief?

☐

Executive functioning meets assessment

Schedules early, tasks chunked, exemplars shown

☐

Predictability across the timetable

Clear information about routine and change

☐

Supports that travel

Consistent guidance shared across the timetable

☐

Visual supports

Clarify what students need to find, understand, remember or communicate

Write down why the option fits: which demand in your design does it answer?

Record your choice, and why, on your A3 sheet, section 2.

Universal Design for Learning

Apply a Universal Design for Learning lens to the emerging design:

- Make important information clear and available
- Offer workable ways to participate and respond
- Support engagement without removing meaningful challenge

Individual knowledge and universal design can inform each other.

Design Multiple Means of
Engagement →



Design Multiple Means of
Representation →



Design Multiple Means of
Action & Expression →



Accessibility check

Run these over your draft design, then test it through use and feedback.

☐ Can students find and understand what they need?

☐ Can they take part in more than one way?

☐ Can they pause, ask for help or recover?

☐ Is the support available when demand increases?

Finish your design

As a trio, develop the change on your A3 sheet, section 4.

- 1 State the barrier or unnecessary demand.**
- 2 Change the environment, task or routine.**
- 3 Include students' communication and experience.**
- 4 Decide what you will observe.**
- 5 Set a time to review.**

Ask the trio next to you to check the design remains student-centred and environment-first.

Check the design against your students

On your own card, test your trio’s design against each of your students.

	Helps	No difference	Needs something more
Student A			
Student B			
Student C			

Where the design still doesn’t work for someone, that is where targeted or individual support begins.

Continuum of support

Support is a continuum rather than a single intervention.

1

Inclusive environment

First, design inclusive environments that reduce barriers for everyone.

2

Universal supports

Then, provide universal supports that many students may benefit from.

3

Targeted supports

Next, offer targeted supports for students who need additional assistance.

4

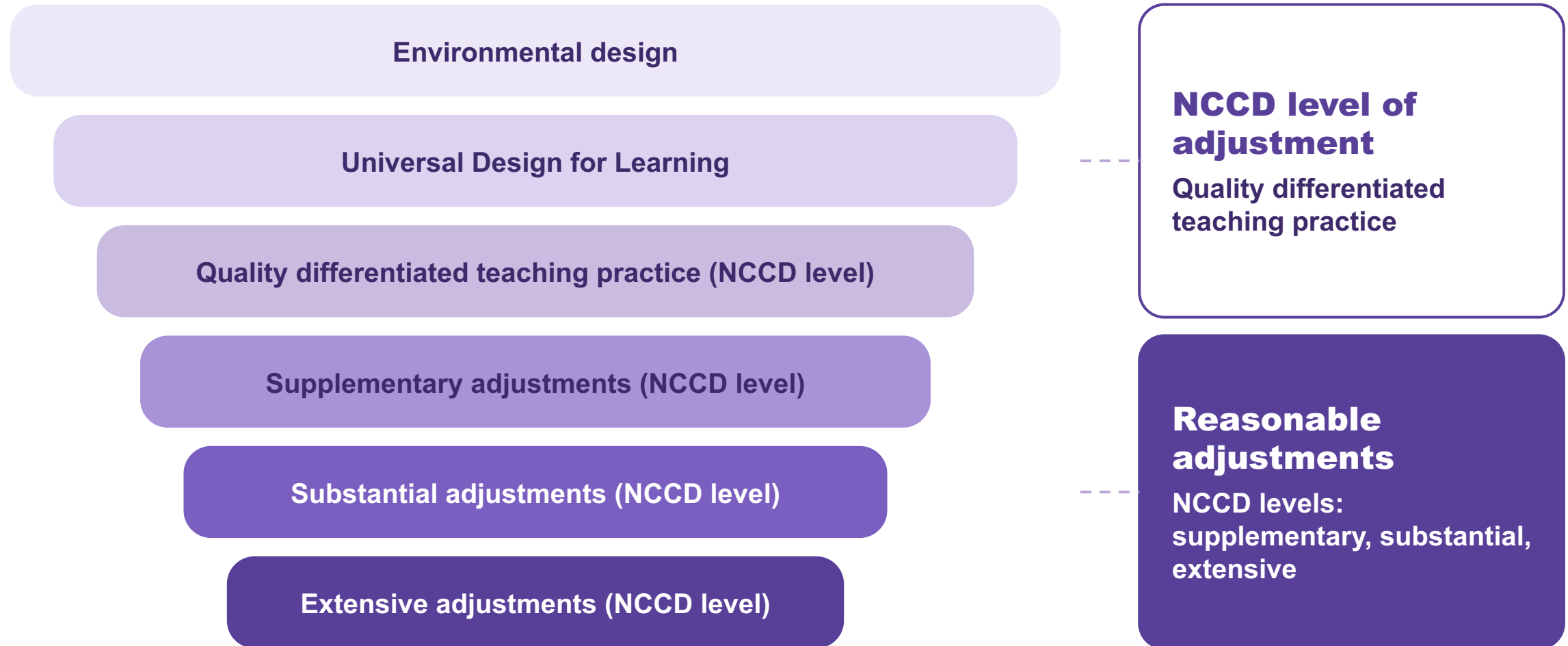
Individual adjustments

Finally, where necessary, implement individual adjustments to ensure equitable access, participation and learning.

Academic adjustments sit within a wider continuum of support.

Consider what is available to everyone, what is targeted and what is individually adjusted. Each response should connect to access and participation needs and be reviewed through use and feedback.

Reasonable Adjustments



NCCD

NCCD information and links

Connect the NCCD discussion with reasonable adjustments and evidence. Follow the consultation, documentation and review processes used in your school or system, and make responsibilities clear to the student, family and staff involved.



Gallery walk

See what other trios designed.

- 1** Put your A3 design on the wall.
- 2** Walk the gallery. On another trio's design, leave a Post-it: one idea you would borrow, or one question.
- 3** Return to your own design and read what others left.

10 minutes, with commit

Share, refine and commit



After the gallery, ask yourself:

- What will you try this week, in your own classes?
- What needs your faculty or year level team?
- What needs to go to school leaders?
- How will students and families help refine it?

Treat the change as something to try, review and refine.